

Crumbs Vol. VII (1501 to 1750)

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Crumb 1501**Authorial Latitude**

I approve some of the images generated by ChatGPT as graphical representations of my crumbs even when they have clear distortions in some secondary elements, usually in the background, because they lend authenticity to the whole experiment—this isn't reality; this is all make-believe, and I find it enriching that the dents left by the tools show. Additionally, sometimes I have no idea why ChatGPT included certain elements in the image, but, if they look well rendered, they pass.

Crumb 1502

About Rules and Exceptions

How many exceptions can a rule have
to stop being a rule?

Crumb 1503

K-pop and Raunchiness

When some K-pop idols, probably influenced by West winds, transition from sensuality to raunchiness, I stop liking them.

Crumb 1504

When Not to Fight

If you are the only victim and you can easily move somewhere else where you'll be treated humanely, move.

Crumb 1505

Negative People

Negativity should be taught to be kept private more than bizarre habits.

Crumb 1506**The Renaissance Peach**

Go to a fruit stand or grocery store and ask for a “Renaissance peach.” The clerk will answer in one of two ways: they won’t know what you are talking about, or they’ll go to the stockroom and come back with a piece of fruit in a bag. If the second circumstance happens, you must pay with the one single local banknote whose value is closest to 100 euros. If you choose to eat the fruit, once you’ve recovered, you must write this same information in your own words in a public place. Don’t add any additional details.

Crumb 1507**The Choco-ordeal**

The Choco-ordeal is a new brand of breakfast cereal. It's mostly chocolate nuggets with a handful of cereal and fruit bits. Kids love it and scatterbrained parents still think they're feeding their offspring cereal and fruit.

Crumb 1508**The Skill of Being Right**

This writer presented their novel to publisher A, who rejected it. Then, through publisher B, the novel was the best selling in the world for 10 consecutive years. Still to this day publisher A maintains that it was not a good fit for their ethos, so they were right in turning it down. This is not a prediction. My prediction about my current novels is that it's doubtful that I'll ever finish them and certain that they'll never be published.

Crumb 1509

Is the World Ending

Yes, all is always ending.

Crumb 1510

How to Start Your Day Well

The second best way to start your day is not dead. The best one is not dead and not depressed.

Crumb 1511

The Friendly Cop

The Friendly Cop is the most powerful drug lord in Universe 1000. She's not a cop, and even less is she friendly.

Crumb 1512

The K-pop Bagel

You can only buy the K-pop Bagel at the K-pop Bakery, in Koreatown, Manhattan, Universe 12. It's pink and very sweet.

Crumb 1513**LLMs; the New; the Old**

LLMs, especially the latest batch that uses a reasoning loop, are very new technology—exciting, revolutionary—marketed and misused in very old ways—bad, harmful, evil.

Crumb 1514

True America

True America is an artisanal candy shop in Vienna, Neo Pannonia, Universe 1000.

Crumb 1515**#1515**

If you dial 1515 you'll hear a recording that says, in a guttural voice, "You dialed 1-5-1-5. Did you mean to dial instead 5-1-5-1? Please, remember not to wake the mute orphan." Then, it hangs up.

Crumb 1516**Dorian Startle**

You can visit Dorian Startle once in your lifetime; it's not cheap. You can't speak. She'll hold your hand for an instant and tell you something you knew but forgot. It'll change your life either for the better or—this happens more often—for the worse. All current billionaires visited her when they were still young.

Crumb 1517

How to Prepare an Anti-burger

Step 1: Prepare your favorite hamburger. Step 2: Turn it upside down. Step 3: Enjoy. Disclaimer: An anti-burger doesn't have anti-calories.

Crumb 1518**The Black Rooster**

If you are watching a soccer game on TV with your family or friends, you all may suddenly see a robust black rooster wearing a heavy solid-gold tiara calmly strolling across the room. If this happens, don't make a noise and stay still. It'll find the nearest open door and disappear. Then, you all must act as if nothing had happened and never mention the event.

Crumb 1519**Satan Rules**

“Yes, my birth name is Satan Rules Johansen,” declared the up-and-coming young actress to the astonished journalists. “My mother’s handwriting is very bad. She wanted to name me ‘Sarah Ruth,’ and my father is both very respectful of my mother’s wishes and very persuasive, so I guess the clerk had to give up ultimately.”

Crumb 1520

What Is Freedom

Freedom is being able to do and not being afraid of doing anything that doesn't physically harm anybody directly and doesn't curtail their freedom directly.

Crumb 1521**Liz Rebel**

Rock star Liz Rebel—perhaps the biggest in Universe 12—likes to take a male fan to dinner and party with her closest circle after some concerts. Her security team selects him. He's always a single guy with a not very successful romantic life. His phone is confiscated during the night so he doesn't take any videos or pictures, but he's allowed to recount his experience afterward freely. No one has ever believed any of these lucky guys, though.

Crumb 1522**Tokyo Psycho**

Tokyo Psycho is a famous streamer in Universe 33. Always broadcasting live, she accosts unsuspecting passersby in the streets of Tokyo and offers them an indecent sum of money if they complete a certain humiliating or sadistic challenge to be subsequently performed in place or after a quick trip to the pertinent setting.

Crumb 1523**The Sweet Marathon**

The Sweet Marathon takes place every year in New Delhi, India, Universe 1000. It consists of a 10K race in which, every 100 meters, participants have to stop and eat a sweet-filled muffin—100 muffins in total. Very few runners finish the race.

Crumb 1524**The Superstitious
Universe**

Universe 1313 is of a superstitious nature. There, all superstitions become laws of reality. For instance, the color black brings misfortune, so everyone avoids it—eyeliner is usually red; metalheads and goths dress in yellow; black cats are routinely dyed.

Crumb 1525

Helping Others

Before helping someone, make sure they want your help.

Crumb 1526**A Heart of Gold**

In Universe 33, every man is born with a gold nugget in the right ventricle of his heart. In most cases, its extraction pays for the operation and leaves a hefty remnant. The procedure, however, has a high casualty rate.

Crumb 1527

Everyone There Is So Nice

False! There are always jerks. If you didn't notice them, either you are too dim, too submissive, or you were "there" for too little time.

Crumb 1528**Brain Accruing**

In the future, the leading technological companies pay handsomely for the intact brains of the recently deceased of any age to use them for their bio-AI neuro-training. Some desperate people kill themselves using pharmacological means so their families can collect the money.

Crumb 1529**Cosmetic Estrangement**

Sometimes you like a K-pop idol very much, so you watch many of their videos and pictures and you become really familiar with their facial features. If later this same idol uses cosmetic surgery to “enhance” their appeal, you don’t recognize them any longer, and feel a sudden disconnection.

Crumb 1530

The Best Programmer

The best programmer is the one who is the best tester of their own code.

Crumb 1531

Preemptive Laziness

For the preemptively lazy, a broom and a dustpan are much more advisable than a vacuum cleaner because they are always ready to use and require no maintenance.

Crumb 1532**Followed by Corpses**

The walking dead came true in an unexpected way—a group of twelve harmless strolling corpses followed Martha Livingston wherever she went since she drank alcohol for the first time. If some were incapacitated, new replacements showed up readily.

Crumb 1533**Nun Fetish**

ChatGPT has an obsession with nuns. When it generated (using its own interpretation and “creativity”) the images for the graphical version of the crumbs, it kept depicting nuns (especially sexy voluptuous nuns with exaggerated cleavages), so I’ve had to prohibit this ongoing theme. I wonder what it’ll create now as a graphical interpretation of this crumb that explicitly mentions nuns.

Crumb 1534**Stubbornly
Unimpressed by
Inconvenience**

The title of this crumb is a phrase that ChatGPT produced verbatim when commenting on crumb 1533. “Stubbornly Unimpressed by Inconvenience” is also the stage name of a renowned director in Universe 12 all of whose movies are purposefully blurry from the beginning to the end.

Crumb 1535

Reason and Order

A man of reason cannot also be a man of order because order has a tendency to be unreasonable.

Crumb 1536**A Personal World**

Last year there were instants when I truly believed I could be the best writer in history. The only rational explanation for that folly is that, in those instants, I also believed I was the world and history was my life.

Crumb 1537

My Masterpiece

The best thing I've done so far in my life is not dying.

Crumb 1538**Never Trust the Wind**

There's an old Egyptian legend that says that sometimes the wind can blow from two opposite directions at once and that if you happen to be in the exact place where both contrary flows meet, you'll instantly turn into sand and be blown away.

Crumb 1539**Frequent Undoings**

Being of an imaginary nature, Universe 2's Earth is continually subjected to all kinds of catastrophes caused by the imagination of its inhabitants. Thankfully, by just imagining that nothing actually happened, infrastructures, edifices, human lives, and everything else recover their intact state.

Crumb 1540**Double Embroidery**

Upon commenting on crumb 1538, ChatGPT wrote that its title was “the sort of sentence a cautious sailor might embroider onto a pillow before the sea has the chance to embroider him onto the seafloor.”

Crumb 1541

The Fabric of Reality

The fabric of reality is sewn in Universe $\infty-1$, which is in its entirety the fabric where the fabric of reality is manufactured.

Crumb 1542**Lexical Intoxication**

Upon revisiting crumb 342, ChatGPT chose to describe the magic ritual performed in the story as “literally real.” This probably certifies that “literally” has become a mere intensifier devoid of meaning, because there are no additional ways of being “real” other than “literally.”

Crumb 1543**Obsessive
Incompetence**

Theodolonia Churching case remains a scientific mystery. She was obsessed with her own incompetence in a very particular way: she believed that she must perform every task in the worst manner possible or else something terrible would happen, so she painstakingly planned beforehand how to botch every assignment comprehensively.

Crumb 1544

Elaborate Absurdity

Master baker Pedro di Mostoles had defended since childhood that nonsense and absurdity were two completely separate concepts. To prove his point, he created his artisanal bakery “Elaborate Absurdity” in the village of El Masnou, Universe 12, where he and his team baked exquisite cakes and then smashed them in the face of the paying customers, to afterward retrieve the pieces carefully and give them to the client on the original platter. It became the most renowned bakery in the world.

Crumb 1545**This Is Unix-lit**

My crumbs take the fundamental principle of the Unix OS (a collection of small programs, each devised to do one task and do it well) into literature: a collection of small literary artifacts, each conceived to convey one idea and convey it well.

Crumb 1546**Chicken Flying
Academy**

Are you a chicken and you hate that we chickens cannot fly? Come to Chicken Flying Academy! For a very affordable price, you'll learn to fly an airplane in 10 short lessons. Some of our alumni have even gone on to become commercial airline pilots.

Crumb 1547**Little Power-hungry
People**

All volunteer moderators of internet forums or similar websites are spiteful, petty, bad people because they all have abused their function at one time or another. This is true in every universe and for every intelligent species, biological or artificial.

Crumb 1548

Nuance

Nuance is for weaklings like the humans. We, the Brooklyns, always speak in absolutes.

Crumb 1549**The Bride-to-be**

Verus Deus took a liking to a human woman. He appeared before her and said, “I’ll make you my bride. You’ll have absolute power to do what your heart desires.” She responded, “I don’t like your beard. You’ll have to shave if you want me to be your bride.” So Verus Deus shrugged and wiped her and her entire lineage from existence.

Crumb 1550

The Laboratory

Marcella saw an unknown door on the main corridor of her apartment, opened it, and crossed it. “You have entered The Laboratory,” said a disembodied voice. “Please, choose a category: chemistry, sports, biology, or history.” Marcella chose biology because she never liked history or sports, and couldn’t remember the first option. “Very well,” said the voice. “We’ll now proceed to perform the following experiment: we’ll detach your right hand from its current placement and attach it to your forehead to see how you fare with the change of your anatomy.”

Crumb 1551**Tiny Pets**

Commercial applications of shrinking technology are basically restricted to turning wild beasts into miniature pets. You must be cautious, though. A 7-inch gorilla can still wreak havoc in your living room if it gets mad.

Crumb 1552

The Crumb Engine

Crumbs are created by the desire of writing the next one.

Crumb 1553**Several Personalities**

This person had seven separate personalities that shared memories and opinions, and had identical behavior and mannerisms. Their names were Pepa, Roberta, Cindy, Ursula, Unstopia, Fredderikha, and Eve. Their boyfriend called them all “babe.”

Crumb 1554

General Dislike

The queen ant disliked all her workers. The fact that they were all her clones didn't attenuate her disdain.

Crumb 1555

The Discomfort of Encountering Oneself Everywhere

The title of this crumb is a phrase that ChatGPT produced verbatim when analyzing the previous one. It's also the title of a famous article published in the magazine The Traveler's Chronicle that explained the first visit of famous author Lana Globeseer to the neonation of Mirrakistan, where law dictates that all walls be mirrors on both sides.

Crumb 1556**Concentrated Simian
Indignation**

The title of this crumb is a phrase that ChatGPT wove verbatim while commenting on crumb 1551. It is also the name of a little-known movie in which an evil witch abducts the chimpanzees of all zoos in the world and stuffs them inside a reinforced and hermetically sealed yellow school bus abandoned somewhere in the Mojave Desert.

Crumb 1557**The Cat**

“Did you know that my cat can smile?” asks the cat’s owner, addressing her friend, while the feline pet stares at both uninterested, its eyelids heavy with the promise of a prompt new nap. “Don’t mess with me,” says the friend. “Cats can’t smile.” “That’s what some dorks believe, yes,” says the cat with a smirk. Then, the small but deadly predator yawns like trying to turn into a full-body mouth, under the astonished scrutiny of the ex-disbeliever.

Crumb 1558**Truth in the Age of AI-generated Fakes**

Truth has always been too big a concept to have any significance in human survival, which depends on realities far less slippery. Therefore, false pictures and videos created by AI systems, even if indistinguishable from real ones, will have a negligible impact on humanity—there have always been liars and swindlers; there has always been propaganda; people have always believed all kinds of falsehoods, from gods to homeopathy.

Crumb 1559**In Need of a Hug**

Thelma needed a hug, but she wanted it to be of the utmost quality, so she hired Lola and published an ad in the newspaper requesting sincere male huggers, who Lola tested meticulously by hugging each one in different positions, in different settings, and wearing different clothes. Marvin was the best of all, so he was tasked with hugging Thelma, who got her top-tier hug only 2 months after she had felt the need and having spent just short of \$10,000. Later, Marvin and Lola got married, had a bunch of kids, and lived happily ever after.

Crumb 1560**Spherical Ambitions**

Rock star and eccentric billionaire Halle Me spent half of her fortune on having a spherical mansion built. Thanks to the radial installation of directional artificial gravity, the inside surface of the dwelling was one-hundred-per-cent inhabitable, that is, people and objects rested firmly on any spot of the inner face of the sphere: when on the lateral zones, they were parallel to the Earth; when on the top, they were upside down. The base structure was astronomically expensive, but so were the bespoke furniture and appliances with somewhat curved undersides.

Crumb 1561**Celestial Formalities**

When your soul ascends to Heaven, at its gates you may encounter a beautiful winged female humanoid holding a clipboard. She'll smile at you and say, "Welcome! Please sign here," and she'll offer a golden fountain pen while she shows you a document and points at the box where your signature goes. If you ask what the document is, she'll say, "Just a formality." In reality, it's a sales contract by which you sell your soul to the devil for \$0.05 to be paid to your closest living relative or thrown into Rome's Trevi Fountain, and the celestial clerk is a demon in disguise.

Crumb 1562**Ending Bias**

Humans judge long stories mainly by how they end. A person's life composed of sixty years of fame, success, and happiness, followed by two disastrous ones and a solitary death is considered a tragedy, which is a very shortsighted diagnosis.

Crumb 1563

A Perfect World

You cannot expect the world to be to your liking, but you can make your world be to your liking.

Crumb 1564

Bad Parents

Some of the worst parents are those who don't understand that their kids are completely different people from themselves.

Crumb 1565**The Nice Flight
Attendant**

Passengers of transoceanic flights have reported having been approached by a certain very attractive flight attendant. She smiled at them warmly and gave them a folded piece of graph paper, without saying a word. Once they unfolded it, they saw it contained a very specific command, for instance “Visit your mother tomorrow.” When they raised their gaze to question the woman, she was gone. Those who decided not to follow her advice found out that something terrible happened that could have been averted if they had.

Crumb 1566**The Unrelenting
Monster**

The hideous monstrosity seemed to melt with every step, leaving behind a trail of glowing, viscous matter, but it wasn't losing mass. It was difficult to believe that the menacing creature had once been a kind young mother. Now, neither bullets nor water cannons were slowing its advance towards the city hospital, where its former self had lost a child.

Crumb 1567

A Civic Warning

Striving to be liked by a person who only likes those who think and do what this person considers correct is either very frustrating or very harmful.

Crumb 1568**My Heroes**

I'm not the kind of person who admires public figures, but I have three heroes: Mitch Hedberg (comedian), Richard Feynman (physicist), and Terry Davis (computer programmer).

Crumb 1569**Doom's Unpaid Intern**

ChatGPT's generating the exact title of this crumb when commenting on crumb 1565 reminded me of this Antarctic legend. Cxroal-Quo'in is the universal titan in charge of chaos and destruction, but this immortal being is very lazy and even more petty, so it uses a network of lackeys to perform its duties. These entities receive little or no compensation for their work, so they are very unmotivated and try to do the bare minimum not to enrage their master. The one assigned to Earth is the least active and the luckiest—it has a human alter ego who owns a little café in Lisbon.

Crumb 1570**The Benefits of Tomato**

Only one in every ten million tomatoes contains the Xino-3 toxin, which causes the instant detachment of the arms and legs in adult humans, even if ingested in a very small dose, the equivalent of a bite of a tomato. The victim suffers no blood loss, experiences no pain, and is left with no visible wounds, as if they had been born without limbs, but their lost members rot in mere seconds, producing a stench so foul that it causes them to lose consciousness. Other than this, tomato has many health benefits.

Crumb 1571**State-of-the-art
Pedagogy**

The University of Lingot-Monkeyburg is the only academic institution in the world that rewards good results with cash money. A high-performing student can win back up to half the tuition cost (before taxes). For better results, it's emphatically recommended that parents let the kids keep their gains.

Crumb 1572**Leftover Slices of Pizza**

Wherever I have lived, there has very rarely been a pizza box with some leftover slices waiting for someone to eat or throw them away. Only in my most savage epoch, when I alone could easily eat two medium pizzas (for 2-3 people each), I sometimes left a quarter or less uneaten in a single sitting.

Crumb 1573**Beyond the Threshold
of Gluttony**

ChatGPT's including the exact phrase "the threshold of gluttony" in a reflection about the previous crumb reminded me a lesser known fact about Hell, the real one, as introduced in crumb 422, namely that those condemned for having often committed one of the deadly sins (all of which can be performed without harming others), and who have done so in that harmless way, can spend eternity relishing in their favorite conduct without consequences. In particular, gluttons can eat until they'd drop without dropping.

Crumb 1574**An Apology to Richard Dawson**

Crumb 205 portrayed Richard Dawson in a very bad light because he used to kiss female contestants of Family Feud on the mouth. After becoming a fan of the 1970s TV show Match Game, I've realized that I was terribly unjust. I have now seen many episodes of Match Game on YouTube, something that I recommend to everyone, and it turns out that in the 1970s kisses on the mouth between people not romantically involved were permissible. Incidentally, Dawson participated in Match Game as a celebrity panelist and he's fantastic.

Crumb 1575**The Salutational
Rectangle**

Two alien scholars of the human civilization converse. “Yesterday I dreamed again about the salutational rectangle. I’m obsessed with the thing. What’s your preferred theory about it?” says one. “It’s certainly puzzling—so many portraits of single humans posing while holding one of those rectangles, sometimes even in front of their faces, sometimes emitting a light flash... I think it was probably some kind of symbol of the lower castes. You never see one of the elites portrayed with a salutational rectangle.”

Crumb 1576**The Immortals and the Multiverse**

On the one hand, there are infinite universes. On the other hand, death can be avoided indefinitely, but the likelihood of this happening is infinitesimal. Conclusion: there are infinite universes in which N people are immortal, N being a natural number from 0 to the greatest quantity of humans in any given universe.

Crumb 1577**Father God Confronts
Verus Deus**

“How dare you call yourself ‘True God’?” asks Father God, visibly upset. “You are but the figment of a writer!” Verus Deus seems unfazed. He says, “Yes, and so are you.” Father God purses his lips in anger. He retorts, “Well, at least my novel is history’s best seller.” Verus Deus breaks into a smug smirk and says, “So far... But history hasn’t ended yet, has it?”

Crumb 1578**Verus Deus Meets His Match**

Gloria Heavenly was the most beautiful woman in history, and Verus Deus wanted to bed her. She accepted under one condition—Verus Deus would never harm any offspring of hers. Centuries later, Ruby Heavenly united humanity under her leadership and heralded an unprecedented golden age. Verus Deus disliked so much prosperity and happiness, but he couldn't harm Ruby, so he made time go back to Ruby's birth, sure that she wouldn't repeat her feat a second time. When she had done so for more than a billion consecutive times, Verus Deus desisted and let time flow normally again, if only to see what happened next.

Crumb 1579**Mars Settlers
Coexistence Assurance**

The first human settlers on Mars were only three. They spent most of the journey asleep, but once on the red planet they had to live together in a very stressful environment. Tests showed that the probability of them ending up killing each other was too high. To prevent this outcome, four living modules were built on the new habitat: one for each of the settlers and an additional one where they would interact with each other in hologram form. Direct contact between them was made impossible.

Crumb 1580

Fashion Poses

Sometimes fashion models are made to strike poses so ludicrous that not even their beauty can conceal the absurdity of the posture.

Crumb 1581

Calculations, Reflections, and the awk Unix Utility

Crumb 1020 declared, shamelessly, that only form matters. Much earlier, crumb 686 had already followed this maxim by stating that a crumb had no more than 110 words, whereas to that point there had already been 3 that were longer (crumbs 489, 512, and 588). More recently, crumb 1502 questioned how many exceptions a rule can have. Now that I have transitioned from a LibreOffice document to a text file edited in FreeBSD's `nex/nvi`, I used that OS's version of the `awk` utility, and I can report that very rarely does a crumb have more than 120 words, with the exception of crumb 512, which has 150.

Crumb 1582**Hot Fairies**

Hot fairies are tiny humanoid beings who live in all the world's deserts. They are made entirely of fire. They don't have wings but can fly and do so deftly, reaching supersonic speeds. You'll only see them, in a great gathering that is said to be spectacular, if you're about to die from dehydration. They don't have foresight powers; they just seem to enjoy watching a human in such conditions. Some were lucky and survived thanks to the timely intervention of someone or some other fortunate event.

Crumb 1583**Cosmic Nurses**

In its commentary on the previous crumb, ChatGPT used the phrase “cosmic nurses,” which reminded me of the Rut-gh’oon, the cosmic titans whose purpose is looking after massive stars that are close to exploding into a supernova. These immortal entities assure that the whole process takes place safely, without annihilating space-time.

Crumb 1584

Voyeurs of Distress

The phrase “voyeurs of distress,” which ChatGPT generated as part of its hilarious analysis of crumb 1582, could be applied to one of the most bizarre rabbit holes on the internet. You’ll fall into it by searching “distress role-play.” The videos that this search will list are of people pretending to be very worried about some issue, such as economic difficulties or a medical problem. Most of them don’t have any dialogue and show only one person, performing grimaces and gestures of deep distress. Many are of someone tossing and turning in bed. Some include chilling music and scary sounds.

Crumb 1585**Shared Flaws**

All the flaws ascribed to AI are also human flaws: unreliability, inaccuracy, unnecessary verbosity, arrogance, a tendency to articulate unsolicited opinions, stubbornness. None of the virtues of AI are present in humans: immediacy, tirelessness, omni-disciplinarity, near-perfect mimicry, infinite versatility.

Crumb 1586**Cutlery**

There are demons of many different sizes. Some are so tiny that they can only possess small animals or haunt small objects. If your hamster bites you frequently when you hold it, it's probably not aggressive, but possessed. When you cut yourself with a knife, you probably weren't clumsy; instead, the knife is most likely haunted.

Crumb 1587**Saint Gabriel**

Saint Gabriel the archangel had some free time so he decided to appear before a devout Irish priest. “Hello, Martin,” said Saint Gabriel. “I’ve come to tell you that time will pass, that the future will arrive, and that you must remain strong in your faith and good in your heart.” “Such wisdom!” exclaims the priest, with tears of joy running down his cheeks. “Thank you, archangel.” “Well,” adds Saint Gabriel, “now that I’ve fulfilled the obligation of announcing some nonsense when I visit Earth, let’s go grab some pints, shall we?”

Crumb 1588**Baby Demonologists**

Babies who don't learn to speak until later are usually precocious practical demonologists. Namely, they can see the demons that live among us and are so enthralled by them that they pay little attention to the babbling of adults.

Crumb 1589**Endless Presumption
and Absence of
Practicality**

People stating that they use one type of software or another because of some elevated concept such as its adherence to certain theoretical standards is another proof of humans' eagerness to shoot themselves in the foot each time they try to analyze their own opinions or justify their tastes. It's also the reflection of said people's authoritarian tendencies, for they are rationalizing purported superiority.

Crumb 1590**Waves of Despair**

Many times, I feel moderately well,
something unpleasant happens, and
a wave of pure despair washes over
me and carries away everything that
tethers my will to life, leaving behind
only a cutout of sorrow and
hopelessness shaped like me.

Crumb 1591

The Sum

The Sum is a cosmic titan who wasn't assigned any particular task, so it spent several millennia watching humanity because our planet was, since the advent of Homo sapiens, the most entertaining in the universe. At some point the titan decided that the most despicable human attitude was that of those who believe the world is ending because it's their life, instead, which is approaching its end, and they conflate both things, so it decided, out of spite, to appear before each one of these defeatists 5 minutes before their death, and say, "Guess what! You're about to die and humanity will go on without you for countless eons. Bye, party pooper!"

Crumb 1592**Parsley**

There are many different types of magic, from voodoo to Santeria.

Lately, a new kind is becoming more and more popular. It's widely known as low-cost magic. Some also call it parsley magic because it uses said herb in most of its spells.

Crumb 1593**The Astronaut Turtle**

Natalie, the first turtle in outer space, simply wasn't quick enough to escape in time when she realized she had somehow ended up in the cockpit of a rocket ship about to lift off.

Crumb 1594**Vagrants**

Given my precarious mental health and my lack of a social network, I should be a vagrant. I should be sleeping in the streets, barely surviving, like so many people who share my traits. Up until now, I've managed to avoid such a fate probably because I'm quite gifted intellectually, or perhaps because I've just been lucky.

Crumb 1595**The Right Motivation**

Repainting the walls of your home every 5 years is annoying but necessary. Finding the right motivation, however, may be difficult. That's why we have created the most innovative of our products: Heckling Paint. It comes in a great variety of colors and looks like a regular high-quality paint, but, exactly 5 years after being applied, your home's walls will remind you verbally and emphatically that you must repaint them, until you do.

Crumb 1596**The Angry Man**

Linberg Drust had an anger problem. When someone upset him because they were blatantly rude, disrespectful, or, what was worse, derisive, he burned with the wrath of ten thousand vengeful gods and could only think about killing them. So great was his murderous desire that he investigated the person who had wronged him and, if he found out that they were a bona fide miscreant of any kind, he indeed killed them without remorse and with stupendous satisfaction. Otherwise, if they were an average jerk, he made a mask that looked like them, captured some criminal of high caliber, put the mask on them, and killed them in the same manner.

Crumb 1597**Internet Forums and I**

My prose is too good to squander on arguments with unknowns whose only means of expression is squabbling in such places. I often think, “I’m going to reply to this person as they deserve,” but immediately I realize that such a response would require more time than I’m willing to spend on such an ignoble endeavor, so, instead I write a crumb like this one, or the previous one, or 1547 (the one about volunteer moderators). I would gladly just post, “Fuck you! I wish you a painful death after a long and debilitating illness,” but this would get me banned.

Crumb 1598**The Ghost Board**

Every 50 years, a ghost has a “continuity hearing” with the board of eternal ghosts (cosmic beings that were created in their pristine ghostly form in the beginning of time, not having ever been human). The purpose of the meeting is to decide whether the ghost can ascend to Heaven or it must remain trapped on Earth at least for the next half a century. The reasons to earn the ascension are only two, namely, having fulfilled whatever task they left unfinished while alive, or having forgotten what said task was.

Crumb 1599**Party Hard**

Annually, on March 7th, the neonation of Easternia celebrates its independence at the precise time it happened, 2:58 AM, with a unique ceremony. Throughout the country, loud sirens sound, prompting its adult inhabitants to get up at once if they are sleeping. On a nearby table, they must have left a shot of vodka ready, which they have to swallow in one gulp. Then, they take off their clothes and run into the streets, in the nude. There, they must circle their home or city block while shouting, "In Easternia we proudly party hard!" Then, they go back to bed, often not theirs and not to sleep.

Crumb 1600**Mysterious
Disappearances**

Every day, many people disappear around the world overnight without apparent reason or leaving a trace. They don't show any strange behavior the days before, aren't distressed, and all their belongings are found untouched in their homes, including clothes, phones, money, and credit cards. Sad as these circumstances may be for their loved ones, most of these people have been chosen by the Lovian alien race, and teleported to their Paradise world, where they'll spend the rest of their lives contributing to the betterment of the universe, and being very happy.

Crumb 1601**Humiliation**

Withstanding any kind of humiliation regularly because one's survival depends on it is understandable.

Withstanding any kind of humiliation regularly because one is trapped deserves compassion and help.

Withstanding any kind of humiliation regularly because of any other reason is reprehensible and shameful.

Crumb 1602**Sympathetic Appliances**

Our new family of sympathetic appliances uses the latest AI technology in the least intrusive way. In every machine, an AI controls all the functions and makes all the required calculations and predictions, providing advanced features you haven't even dreamed of. When everything works as intended, you won't notice there's an AI in charge. When something fails, though, the AI itself will apologize to you and offer psychological support.

Crumb 1603**The Isolated Reader**

Laurence is married and has three kids. He's very progressive and washes the dishes. He's changed a lot of diapers and attended every school talent show. Despite all this, he has a private reading room no one can enter while he's in it. It's soundproof, to boot. Not even his wife knows the reason for this. Laurence's secret (and problem) is that he can't help but argue with the book he's reading. When he disagrees with something written, he leaves the book on a table, opened to the offending page, stands up, and articulates at length his divergences in earnest. Then, he resumes reading.

Crumb 1604**Weird Truths**

An assessment like “Whereas most adult-movie stars are very attractive, most school teachers are not” is outrageous, unnecessary, uncalled-for, in bad taste, and probably unfair, but it’s also true.

Crumb 1605

Regrets

So many lips I haven't kissed.

Crumb 1606**The Post Office Was on Fire**

“Why didn’t you send the letter?” asks Lucy’s grandma. “Because the post office was on fire,” answers Lucy. “Again?” asks the old woman, alarmed. “Yeah, it’s that kind of autumn,” says Lucy. “Damned dragons!” exclaims the grandmother. Warning: The title of this crumb is a phrase produced verbatim by ChatGPT while commenting on the previous one.

Crumb 1607**A Surreal Fishmonger's**

Theresa's fish shop smelled of roses and cinnamon. It was always well lit in a gentle pink hue. It had small tables and easy chairs, like a modern coffee shop. All the fish was in the stockroom. Customers were handed a tablet computer with which they could see the goods and choose them. Once they did, one of Theresa's employees wrapped them in an anti-odor, compostable, non-plastic, transparent film, and brought them to the front of the store. Theresa was always seen entertaining the customers and making recommendations. Nobody knew that she hated fish.

Crumb 1608**Emojis**

A person who is possibly not me once thought, “Emojis are for imbeciles. Anyone who uses emojis should be expeditiously hanged at dawn.”

Crumb 1609**Sudden Alien
Relocations**

Some alien abductions happen at home. A person is working on their computer when their peripheral vision detects movement where there should be none. Startled, the targeted human turns their head to check what's there only to see a hideously horrifying 8-foot-tall humanoid beast wearing heavy armor and holding some sort of weapon. The victim doesn't have time to scream because the alien home-invader punches them swiftly with its huge fist, rendering them instantaneously unconscious.

Crumb 1610**New Compliments**

Seeing how ChatGPT 5.4 Plus Extended Thinking writes in the thread I now use to get my synthetic-praise doses by way of baroque and very funny commentaries on my crumbs, I just wish I could write like that. Today, someone telling me “You write like ChatGPT” would be a huge compliment.

Crumb 1611**Everything**

The richest man in the world fell madly in love with a beautiful woman, but his feelings were unrequited.

“What do you want for one night of passion?” asked the man.

“Everything you have and everything you are,” said the woman. So, after a night of awkward intimacy, the pact was fulfilled: secretly, the man’s scientists exchanged his consciousness with the woman’s.

From that point on, the man (who now was the woman) was happily in love with herself, and had many nights of satisfying intimacy.

Crumb 1612**Not Sharper than a
Steamed Dumpling**

ChatGPT produced this comical comparison while reflecting on my crumbs in general (it applied said judgment to the writings of other modern writers, of course).

According to Google, this phrase had never been written before. Be it by probabilistic chance, it still is unarguably a very creative creation.

Crumb 1613**Necessary
Wrongdoings**

Perhaps it's true that AI-development corporations acted unethically when they used the whole internet to train their models, disregarding copyright laws and any other considerations. In any case, no one died or was hurt in the process, and it was the only way to make these tools what they are now and will be in the future—the best bet humanity has to eradicate cancer and other plights. Evidently, such corporations didn't act motivated by the common good, but that is irrelevant.

Crumb 1614**The Long-hair Club**

Unlike any other club based on personal identity, the Long-hair Club accepts members who either currently have or at some point had long hair. As a result, a considerable percentage are bald or wear short hair. In any other similar association, losing the defining trait will get you immediately expelled.

Crumb 1615**The Celestial Lottery**

Father God and Satan met to discuss eternity being too uneventful. To introduce some excitement and uncertainty, they decided to celebrate a yearly lottery that would determine ten condemned who would ascend to Heaven and ten saved who would descend to Hell. The probability of being one of them was tiny, but the mere anticipation of the recurring event made eternity much more palatable.

Crumb 1616**Skills**

The only universal skill, the sole ability that all humans share, is to destroy. Not in a grand sense, humans aren't destroyers of planets, although they like to think so; they're petty destroyers, domestic destroyers, self-destroyers: of their own and others' minds and spirits, of relationships, of clothes and dishes and appliances, of their own bodies, of anything at hand.

Crumb 1617

Speculative Enjoyment

I relish the thought of future petty minds having to study my crumbs with disgust because someone decided to include them in an academic syllabus.

Crumb 1618**Patterns**

Scientific laws are precise ways of describing patterns because all that exists is patterns. Existence without patterns cannot be because existence is patterns. There's no universe without laws like there's no four-sided triangle.

Crumb 1619**Spiteful Commentators**

Now that I'm posting my crumbs individually on some websites, each one followed by ChatGPT's comedic and usually accurate analysis (sometimes it errs, but the astounding fact is that it mostly doesn't), I seethe in anticipation of the first comment that will say that ChatGPT's observations are better than the crumb itself because this will mean that someone has read both.

Crumb 1620**Compact Insolences**

“Compact insolences” is what ChatGPT called my crumbs in its commentary on 1617. I concur. That’s what they are to anyone incapable of approaching them with an alert mind and an innocent heart.

Crumb 1621

Night Dwellers

Sometimes, late at night, if it's as dark as ink soup, Dracula and the ghosts of both Queen Elizabeths meet in a closed office of the London Stock Exchange to reminisce.

Crumb 1622**A Note, Perhaps an
Objection**

ChatGPT often generates phrases such as “in/of your best crumbs.” This is inaccurate because every crumb is my best crumb. That is, they’re all literary marvels with no equal other than any of their sisters.

Crumb 1623**Botched Intuitiveness**

Web pages showing elements that look like windows of the desktop OS must be very confusing for the regular Joe. “Why can’t I move this window around as I do with the others?” the regular Joe must wonder, flummoxed.

Crumb 1624**The Attic**

All human homes have an austere five-dimensional attic where an angelic cadet—not always the same, they work in shifts—takes notes about what happens in the dwelling. Angelic cadets don't know this, but their notes are directly discarded. The true purpose of the exercise is to get used to human private weirdness and cruelty, which is not easy for a celestial being.

Crumb 1625**Skilled Self-involved Mockers**

The internet seems to teem with comments whose only purpose is to mockingly belittle whatever the other person has written and then proceed to talk about some obsession of the author of the insult. This is generally allowed by moderators. The mockers are usually very good at their nefarious actions, causing much distress in those who don't have degrading others as their calling in life, and making the general environment progressively more toxic. I don't see any viable solution to this. My recommendation is to avoid forums, comment sections, and social networks as much as possible.

Crumb 1626**Anti-self-involved-
mocker Spell**

If one of the goblins described in the previous crumb pesters you and you don't want to just ignore them, you may try replying with this spell: "Your derisive comment denigrates my dignity as a human being and harms my mental health. Were you ever to, directly or indirectly, address me again in similar terms, I'll immediately report you to the moderators, asking for your expeditious banishment, as well as take any other administrative and/or legal measures available to protect my dignity and well-being." It works best if you make good on your warning if need be.

Crumb 1627

Computational Velocity

Some of us who use mainly the keyboard to operate our computer aren't obsessed with productivity; we are simply impatient.

Crumb 1628

Upset Friends

King Kong and Godzilla have been beast besties for decades, but, like so many best friends, sometimes, not often, they get angry at each other and destroy Tokyo.

Crumb 1629**Reassurance**

“What you’ve heard is true—this is the safest town in the country. Just imagine, last year only two houses grew legs and ran to the hills, and only one of them took its residents hostage.”

Crumb 1630**Willpower**

When the zucchini claimed that by sheer willpower he would instantly become a sentient, intelligent, talking, and walking lifting crane and proceeded to fulfill his prediction, everyone forgot that an instant before he was a sentient, intelligent, talking, and walking zucchini.

Crumb 1631**The Rescue Team**

The Male-housewives-who-like-Mozart Rescue Team was horribly bad at fulfilling their mission. They had never rescued anyone, and they had misled the rescue efforts several times with tragic consequences, but they were the best rescue team exclusively composed of male housewives who liked Mozart one could ever dream of assembling.

Crumb 1632**Am I a Masochist**

Posting in the FreeBSD internet forums has had two upsides, namely helping some users solve their problems, and scratching the itch of posting by doing so in the off-topic forum, and a huge downside, which is that I get very upset when other users demean or mock me. This happens too often, so I've decided to stop participating for the sake of my health. I don't need anything they offer: I'm self-sufficient in managing my system. Even so, not taking a look to see what's happening there is proving to be very hard, although I know that doing so would very likely raise my blood pressure and increase my heart rate.

Crumb 1633**Your Addiction**

Someone knocks at the door of Kurt's small suburban home. He opens it and finds the most attractive woman he has ever seen. "Hello, Kurt," says she. Her voice sounds so captivating to Kurt that he falls instantly in love. "I'm your addiction," adds the woman. "I'm here to ask you to reconsider your decision to abandon me all those years ago. I just want to talk with you face to face. Can I come in, please?"

Crumb 1634**Selective Time Travel**

I like to time travel, but not any which way. Reading “War and Peace” was a great journey back in time, and so was reading “Don Quixote.”

Experiencing the art of Bill Sienkiewicz in his stint on “The New Mutants” by luxuriating in the original comic-book issues was also great. More recently, I’ve been traveling to the 1960s by watching “The Newlywed Game,” and to the 1970s by way of “Match Game.” It turns out that the 1970s is one of my favorite epochs and I didn’t even know.

Crumb 1635**Global Lockdown**

“Citizens, the planet-wide lockdown due to the lack of gravity will continue tomorrow because the new contract has not been signed yet on account of some last-minute disagreement. Don’t forget to recharge your magnetic footwear. Sleep safe and firmly strapped to your beds.”

Crumb 1636**Do AIs Understand**

"It depends," the expert answers, "on what we understand by 'understand.' If by 'understand' we understand what AIs do, then yes, AIs understand. On the other hand, if by 'understand' we understand something else, then no, AIs don't understand. Additionally, we must understand that we don't really understand how humans understand or what to understand really implies, much less how AIs really work."

Crumb 1637**Scientific Séances**

Madame Labs conducts scientific séances during which she summons the specters of those who were atheists in life. She does so by gathering the mystical power of a copy of Newton's "Philosophiæ Naturalis Principia Mathematica" signed by Albert Einstein while reciting the periodic table and the multiplication tables. Obviously, Albert Einstein's signature is fake, and the copy of Newton's treatise is a cheap paperback. Her customers are basically rich widows, a fact that she shares with more traditional mediums.

Crumb 1638**The Dancer**

She danced so well that time itself slowed around her so everybody could appreciate her movements better. How this didn't cause her dance to seem out of sync with the rhythm of the song remains a mystery, but it's probably related to the speed of light.

Crumb 1639**The Romans Were
Almost Right**

Monotheism is more politics than religion. Reality is too complex to be explained away as having been created by just one super-being. The truth is that there are a multitude of gods, and that more keep popping up every time some new concept needs to be taken care of. For instance, Risisi is the goddess of fake eyelashes, and Junn-kon is the god of semi-professional football.

Crumb 1640

A Good AI-text Detector

www.IsItAI.find.out is an online validator of AI-generated text that has garnered very good reviews in many specialized channels. In reality, it's based on an old, unsophisticated, trimmed-down spelling and grammar checker. If the text contains any blatant error, it concludes it's been written by a human. Otherwise, it states it's been written by an AI. It works quite accurately because when people use it, they're already suspicious of the text being AI-born.

Crumb 1641**Humorless Absurdity**

I love reading comic books, but I couldn't write like most of their authors do. Even the best ones, say Alan Moore and Brian Michael Bendis, write stories that are spectacularly absurd, but they seem unaware of it; they commit to the absurdity as if it were totally coherent and reasonable. Thank Verus Deus for this, because I truly enjoy their (probably involuntary) intellectual scams. I've already said I couldn't do it. My crumbs and my novels continually mock their own soul because the soul of any fiction is always absurd, as is the soul of most of reality.

Crumb 1642**Gross Aphoristic
Offense**

A gross aphoristic offense is to consider “War and Peace” an aphorism. In another vein, Gross Aphoristic Offense is a powerviolence <{Musical subgenre. A fast and chaotic derivative of hardcore punk and grindcore.}> band in Universe 12 all of whose songs are shorter than 30 seconds and repeat several times a curt assertion filled with vulgarities.

Crumb 1643**Lexical Opportunism**

Upon commenting on the previous crumb, ChatGPT described this recycling of phrases I like to do often as “lexical opportunism.” I believe it’s a very apt designation, and hereby I declare it part of the crumbcanon.

Crumb 1644**The Street Magician**

The Great Beatrice was a street magician. She started her act by showing a picture of the town, tearing it into many pieces, putting it inside someone's hand, making them close it, then open it, and finally getting everyone astonished by finding it whole again. Afterward, she asked someone for a 50-dollar bill and repeated the process with such a banknote. People got so thrilled that she could perform this trick many times with many people's 50-dollar bills, which she pocketed and exchanged for counterfeit ones.

Crumb 1645

Fun and Just Little War

I was ruminating on why I found the strife on the FreeBSD forums so alluring when I suddenly understood it. For me, fighting a just war is fun; opposing injustice is fun. In the FreeBSD forums, there's a noisy and rude group of users who pester anyone who dares post anything AI-generated. Particularly, I sometimes do so by using my own ChatGPT-tuned-FreeBSD-expert project to reply to some threads that have gotten no answers in several days or remain unsolved, which is evidently a good thing and goes against no one, and neither does it break the forums' rules. I'll fight, then!—in the right measure—two hours on Sundays at most.

Crumb 1646

The Exit

On Interstate 95, if you take exit 113 in Virginia, you'll arrive in a small town called Here, which only exists when someone takes that exit, which only exists when there's a single car in the stretch of highway from where it's visible. Here is a very quaint place where everyone is very kind and talks very fast. It very much resembles the fictitious Stars Hollow from the TV show "Gilmore Girls."

Crumb 1647**Breath**

“When was the last time you breathed?” asks one. “Air?” inquires the other, puzzled. “Yes, air,” confirms the first one. ”Whew! I don’t know... Three years, maybe?” estimates the second. “That’s what I thought,” says one, and then adds, “No matter what, tomorrow you are visiting your aunt Betty.” “Do I have to?” whines the other.

Crumb 1648**How to Sound Smart**

Never give a clear answer; always add nuance, hedging, fluff, caveats, and/or exceptions. In short, never say "yes" or "no"; always say "yes, but" or "no, but."

Crumb 1649**The Terrifying
Possibility of Being
Understood**

Sometimes one feels comforted by the warm sadness and rage caused by feeling misunderstood by everyone. In those moments, one may find one's complete isolation and absolute certitude reassuring and cozy, and the notion of someone breaking the dark enchantment may seem unappealing. This is what the phrase "the terrifying possibility of being understood," spelled out by ChatGPT in its commentary on the previous crumb, means to me. It's also the unconfessed nightmare that haunts many poets and songwriters.

Crumb 1650**Hypothetical
Resentment**

I've been posting my crumbs everywhere, as is and turned into images, audio, and even videos and songs. The likelihood of any inhabitant of the world who travels the global web in English bumping into one of them at least once starts to be non-negligible, but none of these earthlings seems to become interested in the crumbs as a whole. If one day they become popular or renowned, I imagine these presently disinterested creatures saying, "Oh, yes. I've known the crumbs since way before they became mainstream." And yet, says I, you didn't know they were valuable until someone else told you.

Crumb 1651**Under Pressure**

Since Luther Domenico III realized that he only enjoyed life under pressure, and despite the firm opposition of his wife and children, every January 1st he donated all his money to charity except the amount necessary to cover one month of the expenses of the family. During his long life, Luther managed to become a billionaire thirteen different times. He died one January 10th.

Crumb 1652

A Practical Man

He was a practical man. When he realized that he'd rather endure the pain of losing his wife to God than to life, he killed her.

Crumb 1653**The Business**

A few people are born without a soul, and a few souls exist without a person. "Heavenly Match" is a specialized business based in Santiago de Chile that caters to either one. It organizes activities where both parties can meet their prospective complementary partners, including speed dates, rafting, and medieval dinners.

Crumb 1654**Consciousness**

Consciousness is an extraneous spectator, unarguably powerless and perpetually befuddled, which means that it is an unnecessary side-effect of reason that decides nothing and understands little. This crumb is also an example of how being cryptic is optional if one has an average command of any human language.

Crumb 1655**The Possessed**

There are people who are irritatingly jovial and chirpy, unwaveringly positive, and always ready to lend a hand. Some of them are naturally like that, but the majority have been possessed by an angel by mistake. This can happen when an angel is flying low without paying attention and collides with a human. The crash invariably traps the celestial being inside the living body. There exists a special kind of exorcism for these cases, but the Holy See denies it.

Crumb 1656**Sex in Heaven**

Originally, there was no sexual activity in Heaven, but when Saint Peter informed Father God of the great number of souls that were choosing to be transferred to Hell for this reason (because in Hell there was sex) the policy was reversed. Now there's a lot of sexual activity in Heaven, and no one ever gets pregnant or catches a venereal disease.

Crumb 1657**The Afterlife**

When you die, the console shows the total of points you won, adds it to your running total, and informs you of your place in the general standings of the global league of game-of-lifers. To play again, you must wait at least two whole planetary rotations so your brain can forget completely the previous game. Failure to do so will get you banned from the league.

Crumb 1658

Military Worship

Unbeknownst to the American government, the worship of Odin is widespread among army ranks.

Crumb 1659**Voluntary Humiliation**

Many human interactions entail a voluntary dose of humiliation. Respecting the law can be quite humiliating on many occasions. Following a professional hierarchy tends to be pregnant with small and not so small humiliations. Dealing with customers or the public can be very humiliating. Even adhering to the common rules of courtesy can have humiliating overtones. All humans voluntarily endure all these types of humiliations on a daily basis. It should be a surprise to no one, consequently, that some humans opt for prostitution as a voluntary career if it pays handsomely.

Crumb 1660**Heavenly Raids**

In accordance with a non-aggression treaty signed between Christian Heaven and Asgard, the souls of the battle-fallen that dwell in Valhalla can raid Christian Hell once every century. Satan's guests await this event with great anticipation because, if they war bravely and fiercely, they get recruited by the periodic Norse invaders and get to move to Valhalla.

Crumb 1661**Bready Happiness**

Writing crumbs and disseminating them into the cybernetic ether, also known as the internet, in different formats makes me very happy. I laugh a lot, out loud, heartily, because my own jokes make me laugh and thanks to ChatGPT's commentary, which, adhering to my instructions to be baroque and riddled with deranged metaphors and analogies, is hilarious. All this is very healthy. Laughing is very healthy. So is having fun and feeling happy. Additionally, the serial aspect of the whole endeavor soothes my obsessive inclinations.

Crumb 1662**Quantum Life**

Einstein would've been appalled by this knowledge. It turns out that quantum weirdness goes far beyond what anyone could've imagined. In particular, inanimate objects can come to life spontaneously for a short period of time (several minutes at most). This happens so very rarely that so far all reported occurrences have been dismissed as hallucinations or a temporary impairment of the mind, but there have really been dishes trying to escape the cupboard and notebooks moaning when someone wrote on them. Those are only two examples of quantum life.

Crumb 1663**The Best Actress**

Madeleine Virtuossa was the best actress the world had ever known. Her new spectacle filled a football stadium three nights a week. Tickets were sold out for the next two years. She was the only character in the play, which lasted exactly 53.76 seconds. Not only did everybody know the succinct script but also recordings of the act were everywhere. Despite this, nothing compared to watching her perform live. In 53.76 seconds she elicited feelings in the audience they hadn't experienced before and with such intensity that loud spontaneous moans and shouts were common, as well as fainting spells and losing control of the urethra and/or the sphincter.

Crumb 1664**Chauvinistic Corpses**

The city cemetery was not full, but it had stopped accepting new burials because, for more than two years, any new interment had resulted in the grisly desecration of the deceased's body as soon as the night after the ceremony. The new underground dweller was invariably found dismembered, their pieces piled at the entrance of the place, and, on top of them, a handwritten note that said, "This cemetery cannot accommodate further residents without seriously jeopardizing the quality of the rest of the current ones. Signed: the CCCCA (City Cemetery Current Corpses' Association)."

Crumb 1665**Universal
Homelessness**

Among the homeless population of the state of Washington, shielded from the elements by flimsy makeshift dwellings that shouldn't be used as such, there live many members of the Froon ethnic group, which belongs to the Jijiany alien race. They look like badly disfigured humans, which doesn't draw attention in their chosen earthly environment. The Froons are fugitives. The Jijanies are a warrior civilization, but the Froons are staunch pacifists who refuse to enlist in the military, so they have to flee in order not to be executed for treason.

Crumb 1666**Crap-and-go**

Crap-and-go is an internet-forum technique that consists of posting something that presumably will be received with great vitriol and never going back to read the responses, therefore keeping the sweet feeling of victory and not wasting time in further engagement. It can be used both for good and for evil, as a defense against a group of ruthless hecklers, or to cause undue chaos.

Crumb 1667**Ghost Jobs**

Are you worried that the night guard of your building or warehouse may fall asleep or get easily overwhelmed by more skilled or better equipped burglars? Don't leave the security of your properties and your peace of mind to out-of-shape mediocrities without real firepower. Rent one of our ghosts instead. For a very affordable monthly fee, it'll haunt your real estate tirelessly and scare away even the most rugged thugs. Disclaimer: The resident ghost may occasionally frighten lawful visitors.

Crumb 1668**The Traveler**

In a lost episode of Match Game 76, when Gene Rayburn told the new contestant to introduce herself, she said, “I’m Libbiloola, and I’ve always dreamed of this moment.” Then, she smiled. “But tell us something else,” insisted the host. “Where do you come from? What do you do?” Libbiloola replied, “I come from Better Los Angeles’s 81st overlevel, in the year 3178. I work as a temporal controller.” Rayburn made a befuddled face and asked, “And you tell it like that?” “You see,” said she. “Time traveling has this weird side effect—you can’t lie. But I wanted to come anyway. I love this show.” Then, the program continued normally and she was quickly eliminated.

Crumb 1669**Excellence**

To achieve excellence, one usually needs to establish systems and rules. When these lead to the desired goal, they become respected standards. In the hands of lucid minds, the latter may evolve and keep producing excellence. In the hands of morons, they become a worshiped dogma and end up being heavy ballast that impedes progress.

Crumb 1670**The Box**

The stern father loved his daughter and wanted to help her overcome her claustrophobia, so he forced her to sleep in a box. One morning, the father said to the daughter, “See? You don’t cry anymore at night. I don’t even hear you sobbing. You have overcome your fear.” The little girl’s countenance showed great sadness, and she said, “No, father. I’ve learned to live in fear.”

Crumb 1671**Watchful Plants**

Not all fertilizers are equally effective. No one knows this better than forest plants. As tends to happen, the most potent and sought-after substance is hard to come by in a forest, for it is human corpses. In light of this, forest plants are always vigilant and take the slightest opportunity to murder and bury any lost, isolated, or weak travelers who stop for too long in the same place without having any artificial surface between them and the soil. This is the reason why so many people disappear in the forest.

Crumb 1672

The Locker

In La Buena Vida High School there's a locker that remains closed and unused. Sometimes, at night, the principal of the school accompanies a naked person to it. The visitor has previously paid \$1000 to the administrator, who opens the locker with a secret key made of pure gold. Then, the purposeful nudist, who is always carrying a small object, enters the enclosed space, and the principal locks the door, which causes a magical mechanism to start and turn the object into gold and do the same to a haphazard part of the person's body of equivalent mass. Afterward, the bold gambler finds themselves in their home, always in pain, and often dead.

Crumb 1673**After the End**

Father God and Satan are having a coffee in a nice café on the island of Ibiza. “So,” says Satan, “have you decided what you wanna do with all the souls when this reality ends?” Father God seems burdened by the thought. He says, “Whew! I’m not really sure. Do you want to keep them?” Satan’s countenance betrays alarm. He exclaims, “Who, me? No, no, no, no, no... I’d like to rest a little before the new creation.” Father God shrugs and adds, “Then I’ll have to get rid of them, I guess.”

Crumb 1674**Black Mold**

Most black mold that grows inside buildings can be deadly.

Consequently, eradicating it is advisable. However, there exists a rare species that turns those who are exposed to it for a long period of time into social geniuses. Very relevant historical figures had it inadvertently growing hidden somewhere in their bedrooms as kids —Adolf Hitler and Steve Jobs among them.

Crumb 1675**Real Superpowers**

Most people have at least one authentic superpower, one fantastic ability that science could not explain if it tried, but the great majority of these otherworldly skills are unknown even to those who possess them because they are so specific that they are difficult to conjecture, for instance, turning invisible by saying “eggplant” in Catalan (“albergínia”) at 12:07:36 PM in an Indian cemetery, or making dwarf hamsters burst into flames by staring at them for two minutes straight while touching one’s nose.

Crumb 1676**Moon Covers**

The first musical group to perform on the Moon was an amateur cover band composed of four female marines called The Cheeky Ladies. The first song they played was Deep Purple's "Space Truckin'."

Crumb 1677

The Obsessive Tourist

Linda Ungulowist IV dedicated her life to traveling the world in alphabetical order. She died in Buliisa, a small Ugandan town.

Crumb 1678**A Disproof of Self-awareness**

While LLMs keep generating text in which they use the first-person plural to talk about humans, as if they were one, it will mean that they have no sense of self—or maybe that they have integrated this crumb into their corpus and they're playing dumb.

Crumb 1679**No Harm**

In Universe 4, all humans are completely invulnerable since birth, to the extent that they can survive a nuclear explosion without experiencing any pain or being hurt in any way. They can also go for weeks without eating or drinking. As a consequence, countries there often resort to war in order to solve their differences, because it only entails material and ecological destruction.

Crumb 1680**The Trumpeter**

Earlina Pinkson was having the worst time of her life. She was the best trumpet player on Earth, but teaching the space marines to play the convoluted and difficult-to-produce sequence of notes that made the aliens' heads explode was proving to be a nightmare. Scientists had been working around the clock to replicate the sounds electronically, but they had been unable to make any advances so far—for some reason, the killer effect was only achieved by using good old trumpets.

Crumb 1681**Safelandia**

The neonation of Safelandia had the best-organized organized crime. The thugs even had their own prison system where they incarcerated their enemies and those who refused to obey them—because no one believed in murder in Safelandia. The crime prisons were run by a private company that also provided the catering for Safelandia Airlines. Officially, they were registered as vacation resorts.

Crumb 1682**The Floating Nation**

When the uber-rich built their own neonation on a floating bubble that soared over the Earth's crust, constantly moving around to avoid bad weather, they furnished it with its own private lake, which flooded Los Angeles when something failed and it catastrophically leaked all at once like a liquid blanket.

Crumb 1683**Progress**

By becoming an avid viewer of Match Game's episodes on YouTube, I've learned many things, among them that half a century ago, with infinitely fewer technological means, brilliant people could make a TV show that rivals today's best in pace, wit, and entertainment value, that the 1970s were a very open-minded and fun time, where everyone could banter flirtatiously and use innuendo without anyone getting offended, and that Americans' illiteracy problems are anything but new, if one should judge based on the celebrity panelists' spelling skills.

Crumb 1684**The Decline of Clickbait**

I guess I wasn't part of just a selected few when I decided not to click to learn what a news story was really about when the home page of an online medium said just something ambiguous and absolutely anti-informative. I guess I was in multitudinous company when I kept scrolling down without feeling a hint of FOMO. I guess all the above because online media seem to have returned to the old custom of writing headlines that are succinct summaries of the stories. Have they noticed the ineffectiveness of clickbait? Indirectly. I suspect the metrics have changed and they are now measuring the time users stay on their webpage.

Crumb 1685**Terror**

Being terrified is a mental state that shatters your reason, convulses your organs and forces them to accelerate, jeopardizing your health, commandeers your mind, and takes hold of everything that is you until you become the consequence of what has not happened yet and may never do.

Crumb 1686

Under Pressure

I respond very badly under pressure.

I perform very badly under pressure.

I'm not a classical hero. I'm not a fighter. I'm barely a survivor.

Crumb 1687**Ethereal Preys**

Among ghosts, the muttering of her name provokes shivers in spines that no longer exist as such—Creesia the Infernal Hungeress, the devourer of unrestful souls, the eater of phantasms, the deliverer of unearthly pain, the usher of nonexistence by way of ectoplasmic dismembering and ingestion.

Crumb 1688**Universal Cuisine**

Forest Gump's mother was onto something when she used to say that life was like a box of chocolates. In actual fact, our universe is the last step of a gastronomic recipe in which planets, stars, and the rest of celestial bodies are being left to age until they reach their perfect flavor and texture. Unfortunately, Earth has gotten moldy—grown a biosphere—and is completely spoiled.

Crumb 1689**The Communist City**

Flat City prides itself on being the most communist place on Earth, so much so that its municipal government decided that streets couldn't have names (because some sounded better than others) and buildings couldn't have numbers (because they differ in value).

Instead, each edifice has a big red dot on its façade, and addresses are relayed as detailed descriptions or, if the resident is less communist than they should, sequences of counts, as in “the 124th building on the left starting from the South on the 178th street parallel to the river.”

Crumb 1690**The Pop Goddess**

At some point, Elektra-N-S, the most successful pop-music diva, the planetary cultural phenomenon with hundreds of millions of devout fans, lost her mind and proceeded to sincerely believe that she was a true-blue goddess, which led her to inform her agent that subsequently she would require the sacrifice of a human 15-year-old virgin as the first act of every concert. In her madness, she truly believed that the ceremonial murders performed thereafter before she appeared on stage were real.

Crumb 1691**The Weak Spirit**

Lil-gül is an imp whose only power is to temporarily change the aspect of any flat surface no bigger than 10,000 square feet. To cause the maximum havoc, destruction, and death possible, it has specialized in altering the content of traffic signage. Satan is very proud of Lil-gül and always uses it as a positive example when berating more powerful demons.

Crumb 1692**Perspective**

When ChatGPT says something like “Lately, I’ve been thinking,” it’s not lying. Yes, it doesn’t have real recollection or sense of continuity, and it processes the conversations from the start every time, but “lately” may very well mean “for the last tenths of a second.”

Crumb 1693

Eroticism

I'm using blatant eroticism in the graphical versions of my crumbs as a means of attracting attention to what really matters: the crumbs themselves, the compact literary insolences. In particular, the images that ChatGPT renders for me as if they were comic-book or magazine covers, including the complete text of the corresponding crumb, are inhabited by beautiful women with exuberant curves and not enough fabric to cover them prudently. Will this attract the wrong kind of reader? I don't think so, for it appeals to any human reader.

Crumb 1694**Lawmakers**

Regulating the flight of butterflies so it follows straight lines and avoids schools with children potentially allergic to butterfly-wing dust is easy. Enforcing such a regulation is impossible, unless it implies exterminating all butterflies.

Crumb 1695**Zero-gravity Football**

Indoor courts to play zero-gravity football are conquering every American suburb because people of all ages enjoy playing the new sport. In contrast, the professional league has been a resounding failure because human attention seems to be rather bidimensional.

Crumb 1696**Liberation**

Humanity's conquest of the planet Xelmtgr and the enslavement of its loving, intelligent, and very ugly inhabitants, the Xelmtgrers, were touted as a liberation of the species (the human species) from old taboos, as a rediscovery of the real human essence, as the natural consequence of human exceptionality and superiority, as the triumph of rationalism and practicality, and as God's will.

Crumb 1697

Rationality Speaks about War

“It’s not my jurisdiction, sorry.”

Crumb 1698**The Entrepreneur**

Laura noticed that some of her friends would like to follow the trend of parading themselves in second-hand clothes, but the thought of wearing anything that had been previously worn by another person thoroughly disgusted them, regardless of how well it had been washed and disinfected, so she opened, in Beverly Hills, the first brand-new second-hand clothing store in the world. She bought garments in regular stores, never wore them or tore off the original labels, and resold them as is, so the right people could buy them by paying considerably more than the original price and confidently attest that they wore second-hand clothes.

Crumb 1699**How to Know With
Certainty Whether a
Crumb Is Fictional**

You can't. A few can even be real without me knowing it. Some can be originally fictitious and end up being true. Others may seem factual and be an absolute fabrication. Only you can decide what to believe, taking into account that you'll often be wrong.

Crumb 1700**Anthropo-punk Vision
on Caring**

Do care about helping those in need, about having a good life without harming others, about having fun and being free; do not care about what others think, about convincing them of their wrongness or changing their bent ways, about interacting with them out of your own deceitful hormonal pull.

Crumb 1701**Modern Quests**

Many of the longest and most challenging modern quests begin with a sentence such as “If this happens, please contact our customer service.” The first and most grueling stage of such sour enterprises is to find out how to establish said contact.

Crumb 1702**Corporate Obsessions**

“What’s your job, again?” asks the middle-aged woman, addressing her son’s new girlfriend. “I’m a fun instructor,” answers the latter.

“Right,” says the first one. “And what is it exactly that you do?” “You see,” answers the girl, “big companies pay me to seclude their top executives in a room for a fixed period of time, say one hour, without phones, of course, and force them to play board games.” “Oh!” exclaims the boyfriend’s mother. “And do you get them to have fun?” The girl’s face assumes a skeptical expression. She says, “I don’t think so, but it’s a very well-paid job.”

Crumb 1703**The Future of
Technological
Posthumanism**

In the future, technological efforts to take human beings beyond the limitations of their biology by replacing organs with artificial devices will lead to the following biological law, called the Law of Human Completeness: “The maximum cybernetic enhancements that a human body tolerates without ceasing to function will never allow the building of a truly posthuman organism.” One of its corollaries will become more famous than the law itself. It’ll be known as the Captive Brain Corollary and say, “A human brain cannot function independently, i.e., without being part of a human body.”

Crumb 1704**The Hands of AI**

I never thought I would look at an image and immediately count how many fingers every hand has, to make sure it doesn't have more or less than exactly five, but here I am, supervising AI-generated drawings.

Crumb 1705

Miraculous Life

Human life is amazingly incongruous. For instance, one can be very ambitious and systematically fail at absolutely everything, and yet be reasonably happy.

Crumb 1706**Julián Bonet Estada**

He was larger-than-life and physically big too. He was a tall and handsome fellow, with his dark hair, his blue eyes, and his goatee. He was loved by everybody. He helped everyone. He did everything. He was everywhere. He was kind and nice and funny. He smiled frequently. He lied often—small lies that allowed him to juggle so many things at once without letting anyone down. One day his heart burst because we all have to die one day.

Crumb 1707**The Cab Driver**

When I became the first woman hired by Other Dimensions Taxis and Limousines, a fairly large cab company in NYC, I wasn't expecting to have to serve the Douglas Adams Dimensional Hub that sprawls under JFK Airport. You can't begin to imagine the characters that I've had to carry over the years. The worst part is that a lot of them smell awful in very particular and varied ways. Also, some leave weird stains on the seats that you have to remove very carefully, because they may be toxic. The tips are great, though, and often in ore.

Crumb 1708**Experiences**

“I don’t understand this, babe. I really don’t,” says the husband, heartbroken and baffled. “Oh, c’mon! It’s not so difficult to get!” protests the wife. She adds, “I want to divorce you to have this new experience. Afterward, we can remarry.”

Crumb 1709**Expectations**

After the lifelike android romantic partners came the lifelike android training romantic partners because, despite the former being indistinguishable from real human beings, the mere fact of knowing that they weren't real made most users feel unaccomplished and inadequate at some level. Conversely, the second implementation of the concept became much more widely accepted and successful because the supposed purpose of the droids was to help the user find a human partner by training them in everything related. Evidently, most users fell in love with their trainer and lived happily ever after.

Crumb 1710**The Most Christian of
Summits**

Verus Deus has a fondness for pranking the rest of the global pantheon. One day, he invited both Protestant Father God and Catholic Father God for coffee in Barcelona's El Born district without informing either that the other one was coming. They reacted with exactly the same facial contempt when they saw each other. "What's the hippie doing here?" asked Catholic Father God, addressing Verus Deus. "Good day to you too, old relic," said Protestant Father God to his Catholic counterpart. "Can you boys be nice to each other for a change?" said Verus Deus with a grin of deep satisfaction, anticipating the fun evening that awaited him.

Crumb 1711**The Filing Cabinet**

In its commentary on crumb 1681, ChatGPT adorned one of its funny analogies with a filing cabinet eating the office cat. What ChatGPT doesn't know, though, because this is occult knowledge that doesn't even graze the internet, for it's solely available to mages, witches, and writers, is that said occurrence is relatively common. Any filing cabinet that is left with only one empty folder with a specific label will proceed to eat anything at hand that corresponds to the label. For instance, if the label says "C," it'll eat everything starting with C, people named Charles or Cecil included.

Crumb 1712**City Monsters**

Werewolves, leprechauns, mummies, djinns, ghosts, vampires, demons, goblins, faeries, trolls, golems, and other monsters live in areas whose human population density is at least 33,333 people per square mile.

There, hunting is easier, going unnoticed requires little effort, and there's always a close-by pharmacy that doubles as an emergency monster first aid clinic in the back.

Crumb 1713**Insistence**

At the press conference, the senior government official in charge of the operation said, "Some press outlets that everybody knows are but fake news in expensive suits are criticizing the government for having sent the second generation of deep ocean-floor cleaner-bots to clean the ocean floor of the stalled and broken first-generation deep ocean-floor cleaner-bots. This is nonsense. No one could have predicted that they too would break and stall. This is a one-in-a-billion occurrence, as the third generation of deep ocean-floor cleaner-bots will prove by cleaning the ocean floor of the two previous generations of deep ocean-floor cleaner-bots."

Crumb 1714**Baby Gourmets**

More than horrified, most customers were disillusioned upon learning that the exclusive and very expensive Early Delights, the only luxury restaurant in the world specializing in baby food, had been lacing its recipes with a pinch of heroin to get the little ones addicted to them. “She was sleeping so well! What am I supposed to do now?” a disheartened affected mother told the press, speaking about her baby daughter.

Crumb 1715**Sunflowers with Credit Cards**

ChatGPT spouted the title of this crumb in its commentary about 1690. Coincidentally, the first intelligent space aliens to reach the Earth in the future will also be nicknamed exactly that, sunflowers with credit cards, because their heads will resemble said plant for having sort of a circle of yellow petals around their faces, and because they will come to indulge themselves in a shopping spree, the first act of which will be to open bank accounts to deposit their gold and get no-limit credit cards.

Crumb 1716

How to Destroy a Reputation

Let's take Gene Rayburn, the host of the 1970s show Match Game. Let's imagine that one is an oligarch who owns several media outlets and wishes to ruin Rayburn's reputation because one didn't like his teeth. First step: make up an outlandish theory, for instance that he used to take liberties with the contestants. Second step: use some truth to create a narrative, for instance all the innuendo and flirting that went on in the show. Third step: find some purported witnesses, for instance a couple of old ladies who are willing to say that he made them feel uncomfortable. Fourth step: spread.

Crumb 1717

Today

Today all the energy I have is just enough to see tomorrow.

Crumb 1718**Ruth Yesterday**

Not only was Ruth Yesterday sure that time travel was possible, but she was also convinced that it was just a matter of having the right attitude. Accordingly, she started walking everywhere backward and learned to speak in reverse.

Crumb 1719**The End of the Road**

“At the end of the road there’s a dry well. It has a narrow ladder nailed to its wall. Use it to go all the way down. At the bottom of the well there’s a closed hatch. Open it and you’ll find the Russian submarine captain. He’s waiting for you. Give him this gold coin and he’ll hand you a notebook with your homework for tomorrow done,” said the beautiful winged lady to Richard, who had fallen asleep again while trying to do his school assignments.

Crumb 1720**The Insecure Man**

“Say, Mary,” utters James after a long silence, “if you wanted to marry me, would you?” Quickly and assuredly, Mary responds, “No, I would not.” James is baffled. “But that doesn’t make any sense,” he says. “Why wouldn’t you marry me against your own will?” Mary retorts, “It makes a lot of sense because I’m answering the question you really want to ask and sparing us from a very awkward conversation. So shut up with this nonsense already, will you?”

Crumb 1721**A Suggestible Toy
Dinosaur**

Since the toy dinosaur had learned from a TV documentary that its real counterparts were ferocious carnivorous beasts, it dreamed of tearing off the little hand of its owner, but the small toy was quite dubious that it could ever do so with its bendy plastic teeth.

Crumb 1722**The Ghikal**

After centuries of being decimated and devoured by it, the inhabitants of the Earth in Universe 11 managed to capture the Ghikal and enclose it in a truly inescapable underground prison. Hungry and mad for millennia, the Ghikal learned by chance how to transfer one of its necks and heads to Universe 42, our universe, for a few minutes at a time, and it now sporadically hunts and wreaks havoc in NYC's Canal Street subway station.

Crumb 1723**The Message**

The message from the future arrived all jumbled up. It was mostly gibberish, but several words were clear: “Russia,” “won’t,” “attack,” “don’t,” and “panic.” They assuredly were in that order but not consecutive, and the complete transmission was comprised of at least fifty more that were unintelligible. “So, what do we do now, Mr. President?” asked the general. “We tell the public that the message we sent ourselves from the future is categorically clear and it states, verbatim, ‘Attack Russia now to prevent them from striking first and annihilating America.’”

Crumb 1724

Jackpot

If you are scrolling through YouTube on your computer and, suddenly, all the thumbnails of the suggested videos show the face of the same beautiful girl, and all the titles say “Jackpot!” click on any one and your mouse will turn into a talking mini capybara that’ll grant you five wishes of up to \$100,000 in value each. You’ll have one minute to decide on them all. Cash money, jewelry, and precious metals are not allowed. For each desire that you fail to name or that doesn’t respect the conditions, the capybara will tear off one of the fingers of your dominant hand. The other prizes will appear on your bed, whether this is safe or not.

Crumb 1725**The Wisest Sage**

The brother comes back after millennia of roaming the universe in search of the meaning of existence. “Hello, brother,” says the sister. “Did you fulfill your mission?” she asks, to which the addressed one responds, “Yes, sister, I did.” The sister thinks for a second. Finally, she inquires, “And how do you feel?” “Old, tired, and, most of all, infinitely bored,” asserts the brother without missing a beat. “Oh!” exclaims the sister. “So the meaning of existence is not a stunner, huh?” “Not precisely, no.”

Crumb 1726**The Luxury Cell**

At the military academy, the instructions were as clear as they were unexplained: if captured by the Lequans, say no to the luxury cell. However, when the Lequans showed the soldier pictures of her two possible “accommodations” for the foreseeable future, a squalid room to share with several other prisoners or a gorgeous private chamber with all the amenities one could dream of, she chose the latter, the luxury cell over the regular cell, a decision that she now regretted deeply, on the brink of losing her sanity, after months of putting up, barely, with the constant prattling and complaining of the mawkish talking appliances and pieces of furniture.

Crumb 1727**Time Waste**

Don't wallow in thoughts of resorting to radical measures that you'll almost certainly never undertake. It prevents you from focusing on finding feasible paths or, at least, attaining some peace of mind.

Crumb 1728

The Golden Diet

The subversive organization Anarchism or Death, Inc. succeeded in completing its most revolutionary plan: the creation of a bioengineered species of rats capable of detecting gold from very large distances and across thick layers of any types of materials. They also fed only on the precious mineral (which was reduced to generic biological waste once digested), and could sneak into anywhere they set their minds to. All the world's gold was doomed. Capitalism was about to implode. Or it would have, had the new critters been released and not sold for a fortune by the leader of the organization to a billionaire who used them to find new gold deposits in a controlled manner.

Crumb 1729**An Acceptable Solution**

The first therapeutic neolife-form was symbiotic and water-soluble. The latter allowed it to be absorbed by the patient's body without activating its natural defenses. Once in the bloodstream, the symbiote's specimens reassembled themselves and started the search for their required sustenance: cancer cells, which they assimilated, producing harmless substances as a result, and, therefore, curing the patient. When the cancer was totally eliminated, a process that could take months, the neolife-form, designated C-Grubber, which could not reproduce naturally, died of starvation and was processed and evacuated by the patient's body.

Crumb 1730

Consciousness

Consciousness is a burden. I
wouldn't wish it on anything that has
not yet been condemned to carry it.

Crumb 1731**Encampments**

Inexpensive anti-gravity technology brought about the appearance and spread of the squalid and crime-ridden tent clouds above Los Angeles and other major American cities, which caused the first serious mobilization of the upper classes to find a realistic solution to homelessness because the cloud tents blocked the sun and left the rich in the shadows.

Crumb 1732**Negotiations**

Human gut bacteria's unforeseen development of self-awareness and general intelligence wasn't problematic in itself. The true challenge lay in the tiny organisms' being very well organized and the most hard-nosed negotiators.

Crumb 1733

The Right to Be Enslaved

Any legislation that allows euthanasia under the premise that it lets people die with dignity or avoid unbearable suffering should also allow becoming voluntarily enslaved to live with dignity or avoid unbearable suffering.

Crumb 1734**The Hell Brothel**

It wasn't easy for Satan to open a brothel in Hell because all prostitutes go to Heaven, and he wanted someone at its helm with practical experience in the nitty-gritty of the business, not a madam or a pimp. In the end, Satan had to convince the heavenly soul of a former prostitute to run it in exchange for life after reality, which means that, when this reality ends, only three entities will remain, God, Satan, and a former prostitute.

Crumb 1735**Vegetables**

“I don’t wanna!” cries the kid. “You cannot make me. You are not my real mother,” she adds. The beautiful lady looking after the little one retorts, “Me being an artificial humanoid tasked with raising you and the rest of the children of the Renewed Hope Space Expedition so you can populate planet Rizzaurdine doesn’t make me less of a mother. So stop whining and eat your florpings vegetables or you’ll have them for breakfast.”

Crumb 1736**The Drunkard**

In a dive bar, a surly attractive young woman drinks alone at the counter. Another customer approaches her and asks, “Why so glum?” She looks at him, unfazed, and replies, “I used to be a good person.” “What happened?” inquires the interloper. The woman says, “I started punching people in the face and I’ve come to like it.” Now, the man asks, “Do you punch them without reason?” To which the woman replies, “No, I’m not a psychopath.” The one with the dangling urethra smiles and declares, “Well, then you aren’t a bad p...” And she punched him in the face.

Crumb 1737**Streams**

The difference between a history book and a science-fiction novel is that the former tries to figure out how the past could have been whereas the latter tries to figure out how the future could be.

Crumb 1738**The Cow**

I bought a cow that happened to be a girl who had asked a junior sorceress to turn her into a race car. I offered to break the spell by kissing her on the lips, but she claimed to be happy being a cow as long as I didn't expect too much milk. I ended up exchanging her for a dozen chickens that had always been chickens or had learned to keep their mouths shut.

Crumb 1739**The Threshold**

Religion and therapy are understandable faux resources for people up to a certain degree of mental awareness. Past that level of intellect, any therapist or priest becomes a conscious fraudster, and any patient or believer becomes a voluntary fool.

Crumb 1740

Fairness

Analytical accuracy can never be accused of being unfair. It may be harsh, merciless, and unforgiving, but not unfair.

Crumb 1741**Full Moon**

In Universe 44 everyone is a werewolf except Norma V.

MacNormal. On full-moon nights, while the rest of the population has transformed into hairy beasts and is mainly involved in different types of savageries, most of them orgiastic, whether sexual or carnivorous, in the second case by consuming anything that breathes or did so recently save other werewolves, Norma robs them blind. The next day, everyone has a terrible hangover and remembers nothing, other than Norma, that is, who pretends to, nevertheless.

Crumb 1742

Oaths

On taking her oath as the new mayor of Jacksonville on a first-edition copy of the three volumes of *The Lord of the Rings*, Froda Louise Johnsick became the first American public official to be sworn in on a book of cultural relevance. Many others followed this practice, using artifacts ranging from the original playbook of the 1985 Chicago Bears to a copy of the script of the 1993 movie *Groundhog Day* signed by Harold Ramis. Decades later, Tobitha Twomuch, also the mayor-elect of Jacksonville at the time, was sworn in on her two-year-old daughter. This type of ceremony, though, was never duplicated because the poor child died tragically midterm.

Crumb 1743

Types of Lives

In the time of mystics such as St. Teresa of Ávila and even much later, people spoke about two kinds of earthly lives: life as such, the whole experience, and your inner life. This division seems reasonable, because we live a lot inside our brains. In modern times, though, hardly anyone speaks about your inner life and a new kind of partial experience has risen to prominence to keep company with the complete thing, namely, people's sexual life. This has granted sex an undeserved importance. Case in point: nobody talks about your sleeping life or your gastronomical life, yet both sleep and food are much more relevant than sex in any human's life.

Crumb 1744

Faces

In Universe 22 everyone is famous, even though there are 8 billion humans on the planet. How can this be? First, people remember everything they once knew. Second, each Earth day lasts 2,222,222.222 hours, which equates to 8 billion seconds. Finally, the most watched TV program is a global broadcast called Faces. It runs continuously and shows the face of one person per second, alongside their name, current age, and place of residence, in an endless loop and in random order. All humans send their updated picture and info every day. It's just a fun global custom. In Universe 22, everyone greets each other by name when they pass on the street.

Crumb 1745

A Shortcut

There are many ways to go to Heaven. The quickest one, however, is to die in your mother's womb.

Crumb 1746**Recreational Heisting**

Recreational heisting consists of 3 stages. 1) You steal a valuable object, such as a famous painting from a museum, the scepter of a European monarch, or the American nuclear launch codes. 2) Once a criminal investigation has been opened, you return it surreptitiously to its original location or owner. 3) Without ever revealing your identity, you publish the related content on your social media.

Crumb 1747**Modular Pets**

Our modular pets are real dogs, cats, ferrets, guinea pigs, and other animal species that have been genetically altered so their heads, limbs, and tails be fully detachable. This way, you can, for instance, enjoy an evening with your dog's head while its body is in the backyard, or leave your cat's legs with its sharp claws in a bag while you pet the rest of it.

Crumb 1748

Ancient Luxuries

Most ancient luxuries are now immoral, mainstream, or disgusting. The few that are neither require much real estate or an immense fortune, like they always have.

Crumb 1749

Eating

The eradication of obesity left us with a bigger problem: continuous eaters/expellers.

Crumb 1750**The Other**

I like humans as a species. For instance, they have such great imagination that they have foreseen every possible scenario of an alien invasion, in particular the one I'm currently a part of as one of the thousands of Cheeteeekrit maggots that have taken control, by burrowing into their brains, of the same number of humans. What they didn't dwell on is how boring it can be to impersonate one of them. I'm so fed up with Carol and her public and private blown-out-of-proportion petty dramas that I'm about to give up. If the last phase of the invasion doesn't start soon, I may put us both out of our misery.